statement, Woodward said, 'Zardari had just given the CIA an important green light'.

As the *Wall Street Journal* reports:

> About once a month, the Central Intelligence Agency sends a fax to a general at Pakistan's intelligence service outlining broad areas where the US intends to conduct strikes with drone aircraft, according to US officials. The Pakistanis, who in public oppose the program, don't respond. On this basis, plus the fact that Pakistan continues to clear airspace in the targeted areas, the US government concludes it has tacit consent to conduct strikes within the borders of a sovereign nation.

Opposition political parties and the public had been quite critical of drone attacks. The PML (N) Chief Nawaz Sharif insinuated in an interview in June 2012 that drone attacks were being carried out with the connivance of the Pakistan government, which condemned the attacks but looked the other way when they took place. Imran Khan, cricketer turned politician, chief of Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI), claimed in a public gathering at Swabi, KP, that if he came into power, he would order to shoot down drones and if he failed to do so, he would resign.

A poll conducted by *The Express Tribune* in February 2012 showed that 79 per cent were in favour of shooting down the US drones entering Pakistan airspace, whereas the remaining 21 per cent voted against it (*The Express Tribune*, 2012). Probably this popular sentiment encouraged Imran Khan, chairman of PTI, to announce during his election campaign that if he came to power he would order to shoot down the drones.

Solution to drone campaign controversy

The drone campaign was a complex affair. It had generated a lot of controversies in Pakistan, which overshadowed its achievements. There were four parties to the drone campaign, for instance, the US, militants/terrorists, the Government of Pakistan (GoP) and the people of Pakistan. Two parties are directly engaged in this tussle, for instance, the US and the Al Qaeda/TTP militants. The other two, the government of Pakistan and the people of Pakistan, were dragged into it as unavoidable